

MATSE: Operations Research

Lecture 9. Game Theory

[based on slides and notes by: Frank Thuijsman, Steven Chaplick]

Two-Player, Zero-Sum Games

Setup: Two players Alice and Bob act **simultaneously**
 (Alice uses strategy a_i ; Bob uses b_j)
 Alice's score is s_{ij} and Bob's is $-s_{ij}$

Alice's payoff matrix	B plays	
	A plays	$b_1 \quad b_2$
	a_1	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$
	a_2	$\begin{bmatrix} 4 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$

Bob's payoff matrix	B plays	
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Called **Zero-Sum** because each play (a_i, b_j) leads to a total score of **zero**.

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 To analyze such games, we must assume *rational* players.

- If we know Alice's play, then Bob can plan a "best" counter strategy.
- But, players act simultaneously, maybe one strategy is more likely than another?
 $\leadsto$ Analyze such games by probabilistic play!

Two-Player, Zero-Sum

Some games have redundant options , or a deterministic strategy.

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- Maybe some rows (cols.) would never be played ...

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		B plays		Would Alice every play the new row a_3 ?
A plays				
	a_1	a_2	a_3	
	b_1	b_2		
	1	3		
	4	2		
	3	1		

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What if Alice plays a_1 ?

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But Bob playing $b_1 \rightsquigarrow$ Alice playing a_2

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unstable! :(

Saddle points

When does a game have a **pure** strategy, i.e., where Alice picks a_i and Bob picks b_j ?

		B plays		
		b_1	b_2	b_3
A plays	a_1	1	3	0
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- (i, j) is a **saddle point**, when S_{ij} is both the min entry in row i and the max entry in col j .

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stable!

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- (i, j) is a **saddle point**, when S_{ij} is both the min entry in row i and the max entry in col j .
 $\rightsquigarrow$ A saddle point (i, j) provides an *optimal* solution, the *value* being S_{ij} for Alice and $-S_{ij}$ for Bob.

Multiple Saddle Points

What if there are multiple saddle points?

Suppose that an $(n \times m)$ matrix S has two saddle points (i, j) and (i', j') . Show that

(a) $S_{ij} = S_{i'j'}$, and (b) (i', j) and (i, j') are also saddle points.

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Consider (i', j) and (i, j') :

- $S_{i'j}$ is in the same column j of S_{ij}

$\Rightarrow S_{i'j} \leq S_{ij}$ because (i, j) is a saddle point
It is the max entry in the column

- $S_{i'j}$ is in the same row i' of $S_{i'j'}$

$\Rightarrow S_{i'j} \geq S_{i'j'}$ because (i', j') is a saddle point
It is the min entry in the row

- $S_{ij'}$ is in the same column j' of $S_{i'j'}$

$\Rightarrow S_{ij'} \leq S_{i'j'}$

- $S_{ij'}$ is in the same row i of S_{ij}

$\Rightarrow S_{ij'} \geq S_{ij}$

$$\begin{bmatrix} S_{ij} & S_{ij'} \\ S_{i'j} & S_{i'j'} \end{bmatrix}$$

Two-Player, Zero-Sum Games

Probabilistic play.

Alice's payoff matrix

Bob's loss matrix

B plays

A plays

	b_1	b_2
a_1	1	3
a_2	4	2

Two-Player, Zero-Sum Games

Probabilistic play.

- Alice plays a_2 with prob. p , and a_1 with prob. $1 - p$.

Alice's
payoff
matrix

Bob's loss matrix

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Probabilistic play.

- Alice plays a_2 with prob. p , and a_1 with prob. $1 - p$.
- What p should Alice pick?

Alice's
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$1-p$
 p

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- What p should Alice pick?
best guaranteed payoff

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Probabilistic play.

- Alice plays a_2 with prob. p , and a_1 with prob. $1 - p$.
- What p should Alice pick?
best guaranteed payoff
 pick p to max the min payoff.

Alice's
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Bob's loss matrix

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		$1-p$	
		p	

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$1-p$
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- What p should Alice pick?
best guaranteed payoff
 pick p to max the min payoff.
- What q should Bob pick?

$\Rightarrow$ Expected Payoff

$\Rightarrow$ Graphical Method

Alice's
payoff
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Bob's loss matrix

B plays

A plays

	b_1	b_2	
a_1	1	3	$1-p$
a_2	4	2	p
	$1-q$	q	

Two-Player, Zero-Sum Games

Alice's payoff matrix

Bob's loss matrix

		B plays	
A plays	$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{4}$	$\frac{3}{4}$
	$\frac{1}{2}$	1	3
	$\frac{1}{2}$	4	2

Strategies $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2})$ for A, $(\frac{1}{4}, \frac{3}{4})$ for B are **optimal** since they both ensure to **maximize the minimum payoff** and (symmetrically) both **minimize the maximum loss**.

The game's **value** is this max min payoff for the first player, here **2.5**.

Two-Player, Zero-Sum Games

Alice's
payoff
matrix

Bob's loss matrix

		B plays	
A plays	$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{4}$	$\frac{3}{4}$
	$\frac{1}{2}$	1	3
	$\frac{1}{2}$	4	2
	$\frac{1}{2}$		

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John von Neumann

[1928] The MiniMax Theorem

Every $(n \times m)$ matrix S has a **value**, i.e., there is a unique number v with

$$\max_x \min_y xSy^T = v = \min_y \max_x xSy^T$$

row vectors $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and $y \in \mathbb{R}^m$

A bigger example

B plays				
A plays		b_1	b_2	b_3
	a_1	0	-2	5
	a_2	4	10	-1
	a_3	3	2	-3

A bigger example

		B plays		
A plays		b_1	b_2	b_3
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- Check for dominated rows/cols

A bigger example

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- Check for dominated rows/cols any more?

p

A bigger example

		B plays		
A plays		b_1	b_2	b_3
	a_1	0	-2	5
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- Check for dominated rows/cols
any more? No!
- Check for saddle points

A bigger example

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- Check for dominated rows/cols
any more? No!
- Check for saddle points
no saddle points $\rightsquigarrow$ consider a mixed strategy

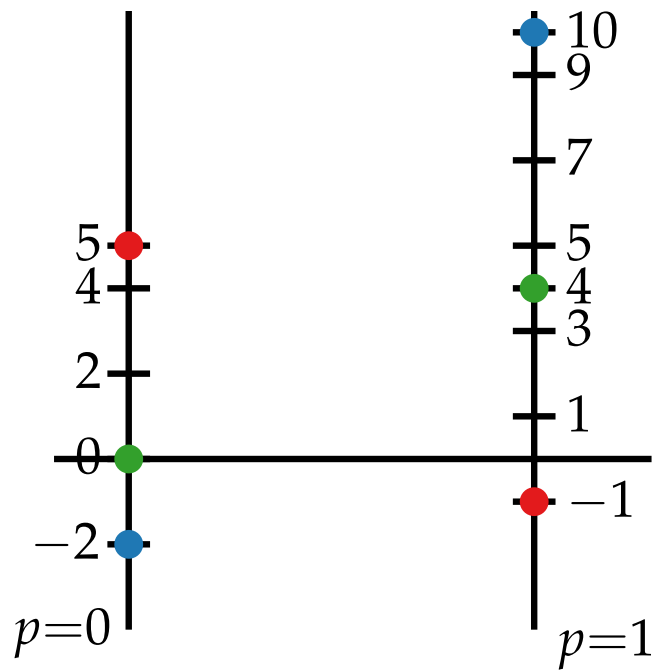
p

A bigger example

		B plays		
		q_1	q_2	q_3
A plays	$1-p$	a_1	$\begin{bmatrix} 0 & -2 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$	
	p	a_2	$\begin{bmatrix} 4 & 10 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$	

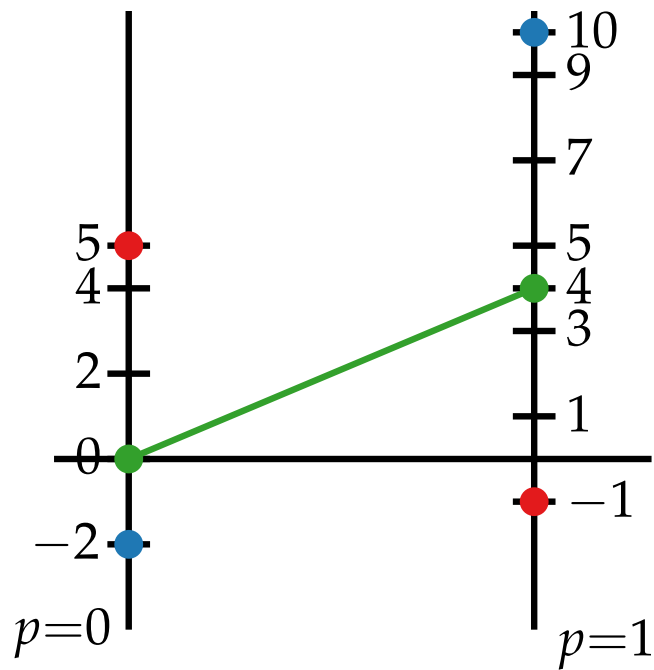
A bigger example

		B plays		
		q_1	q_2	q_3
A plays	b_1	b_1	b_2	b_3
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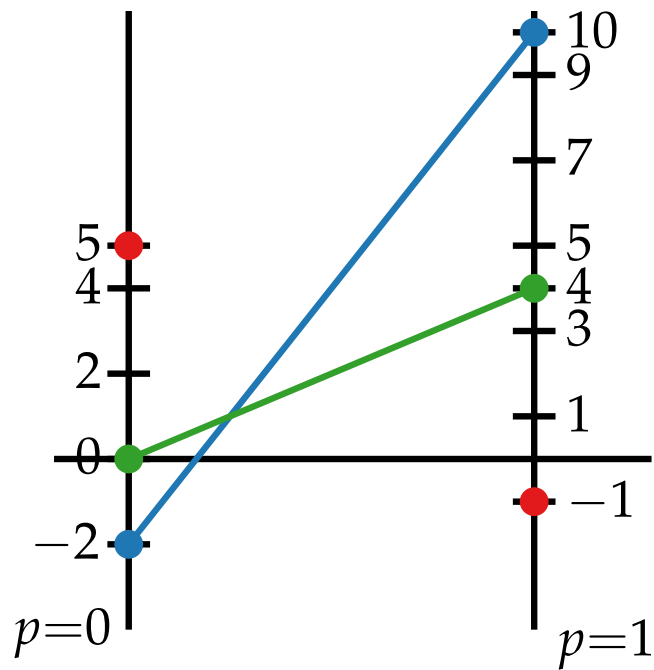
A bigger example

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A plays	b_1	b_1	b_2	b_3
	a_1	0	-2	5
	a_2	4	10	-1
		$4p$		



A bigger example

		B plays		
		q_1	q_2	q_3
A plays	b_1	b_1	b_2	b_3
	$1-p$ a_1	0	-2	5
	p a_2	4	10	-1
		$4p$	$12p-2$	

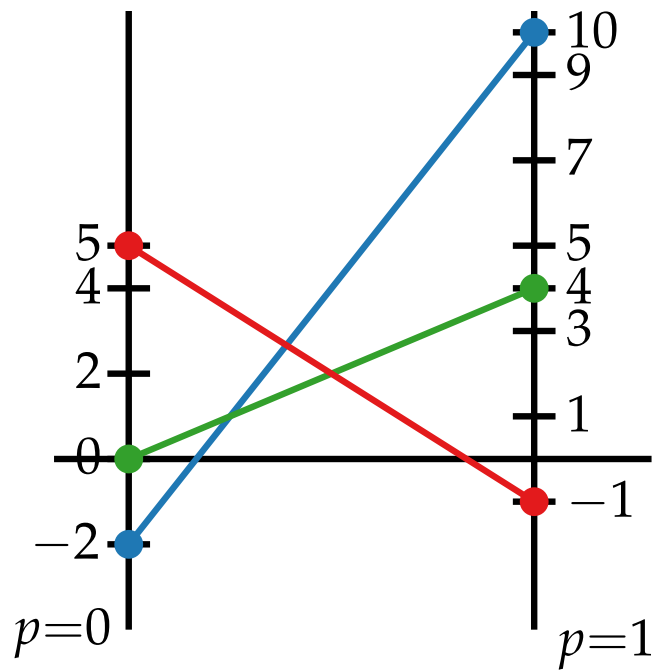


A bigger example

B plays q_1 q_2 q_3

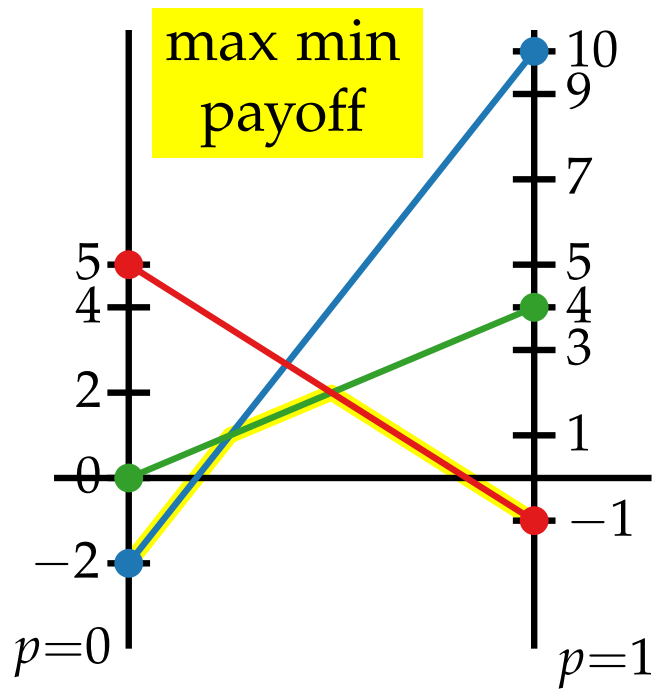
A plays b_1 b_2 b_3

$1-p$ a_1	0	-2	5
p a_2	4	10	-1
	$4p$	$12p-2$	$5-6p$



A bigger example

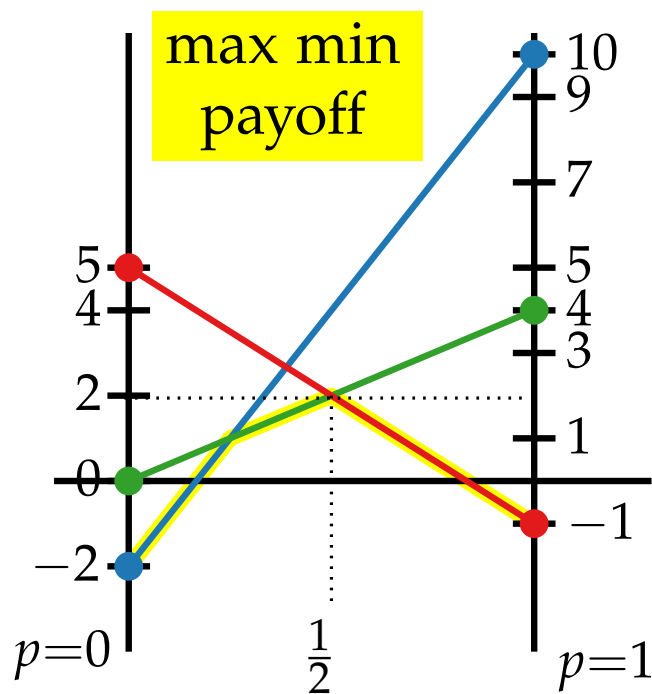
		B plays		
		q_1	q_2	q_3
A plays	b_1	0	-2	5
	b_2	4	10	-1
$1-p$ a_1		$4p$	$12p-2$	$5-6p$
p a_2				



A bigger example

		B plays		
		q_1	q_2	q_3
A plays	b_1	b_1	b_2	b_3
	a_1	0	-2	5
	a_2	4	10	-1
		$4p$	$12p-2$	$5-6p$

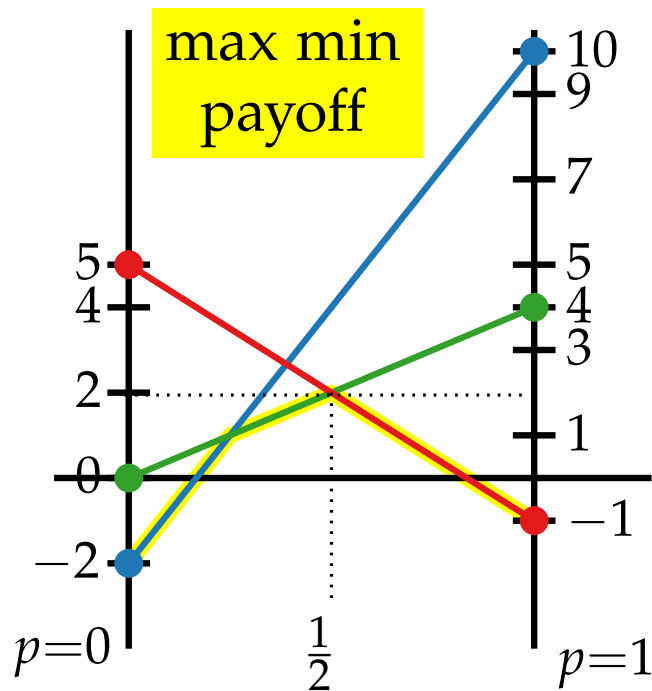
Thus, $p = \frac{1}{2}$, and the **value** v^* of the game is 2.



A bigger example

		B plays		
		q_1	q_2	q_3
A plays	b_1	b_1	b_2	b_3
	a_1	0	-2	5
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		$4p$	$12p-2$	$5-6p$

Thus, $p = \frac{1}{2}$, and the **value** v^* of the game is 2.
 But, we didn't find $\mathbf{q} = (q_1, q_2, q_3) \dots$



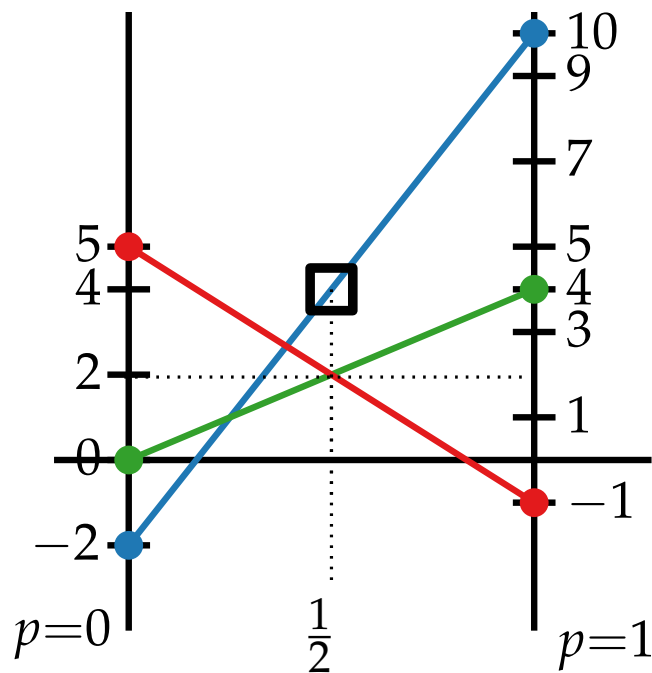
A bigger example

		B plays		
		q_1	q_2	q_3
A plays	$1-p$ a_1	b_1	b_2	b_3
	p a_2	b_1	b_2	b_3
		$4p$	$12p-2$	$5-6p$

Thus, $p = \frac{1}{2}$, and the **value** v^* of the game is 2.

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$$\Rightarrow q_2 = 0$$



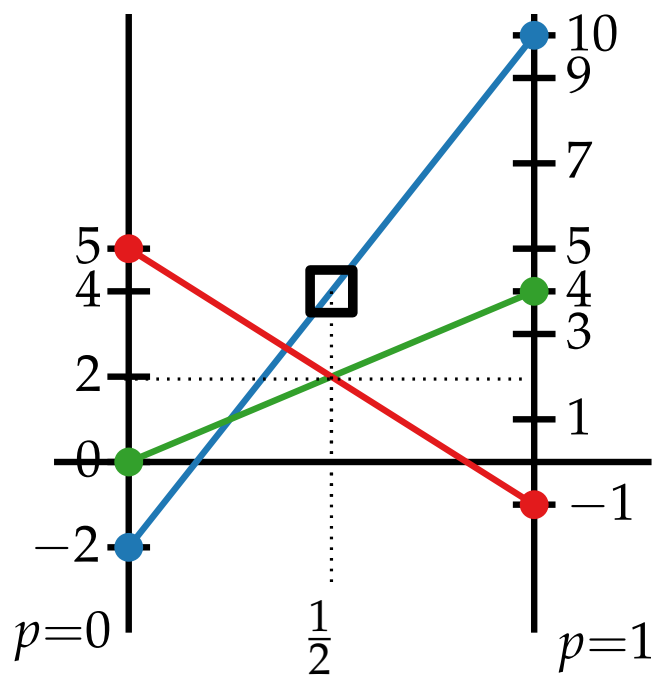
A bigger example

		B plays		
		q_1	q_2	q_3
A plays	$1-p$ a_1	b_1	b_2	b_3
	p a_2	b_1	b_2	b_3
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A bigger example

B plays $q_1 \quad q_2 \quad q_3$

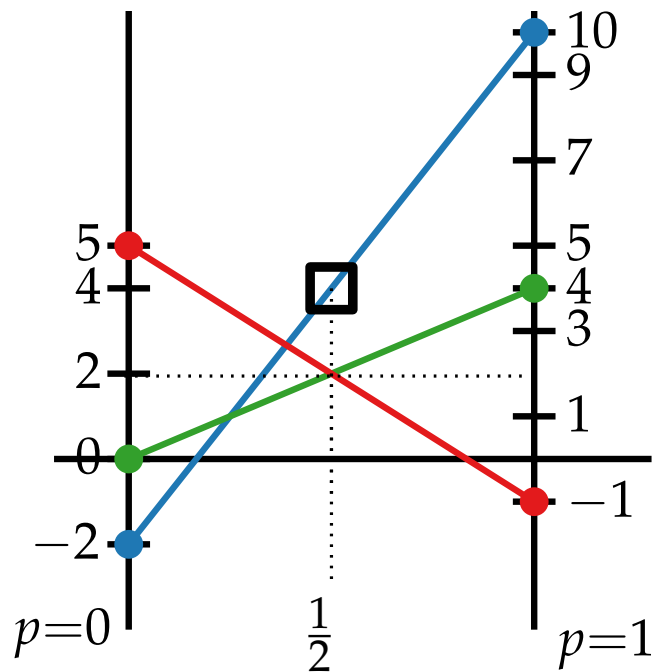
A plays a_1 a_2

$$\begin{array}{c}
 1-p \\
 p
 \end{array}
 \begin{bmatrix}
 0 & -2 & 5 \\
 4 & 10 & -1
 \end{bmatrix}
 \begin{array}{c}
 -2q_2 + 5q_3 \\
 4p \quad 12p-2 \quad 5-6p
 \end{array}$$

Thus, $p = \frac{1}{2}$, and the **value** v^* of the game is 2.

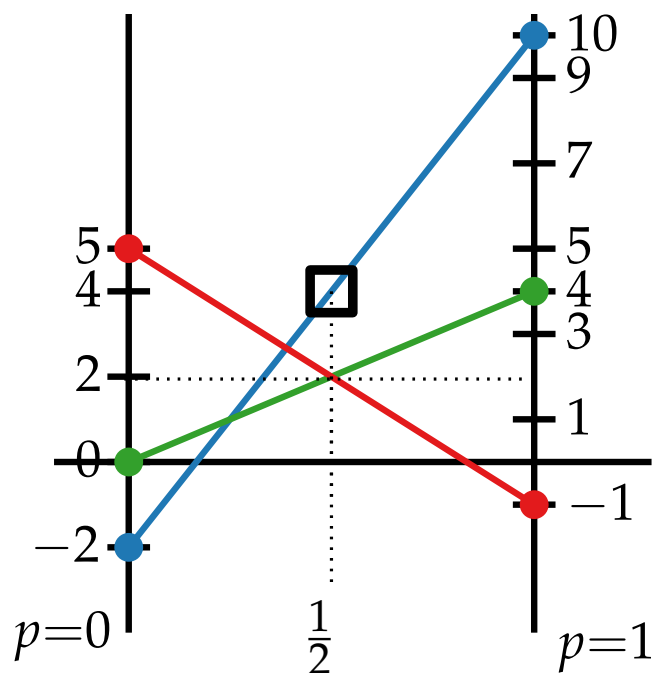
But, we didn't find $\mathbf{q} = (q_1, q_2, q_3) \dots$

$$\Rightarrow q_2 = 0$$



A bigger example

		B plays			
		q_1	q_2	q_3	
A plays	a_1	b_1	b_2	b_3	$-2q_2 + 5q_3$
	a_2	b_1	b_2	b_3	$4q_1 + 10q_2 - 1q_3$
$1-p$		0	-2	5	
p		4	10	-1	
		$4p$	$12p-2$	$5-6p$	



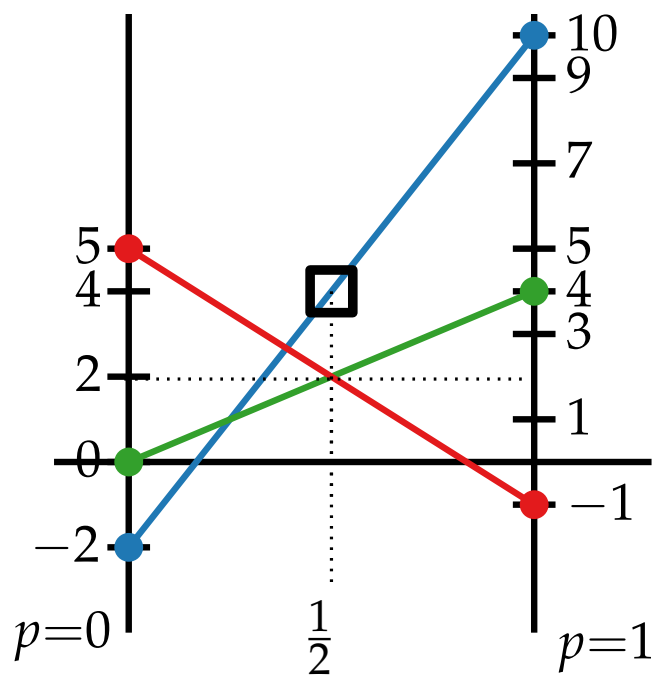
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A bigger example

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	b_2	4	10	-1	$4q_1 + 10q_2 - 1q_3$
$1-p$ a_1		$4p$	$12p-2$	$5-6p$	
p a_2					



Thus, $p = \frac{1}{2}$, and the **value** v^* of the game is 2.

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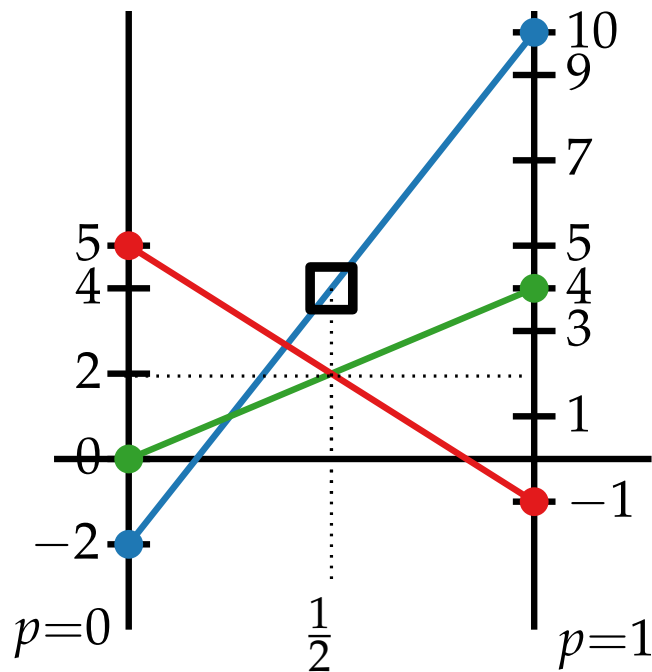
[Minimax thm. $\mathbf{pS}\mathbf{q}^T = v^*$]

$$(1-p)(-2q_2 + 5q_3) + p(4q_1 + 10q_2 - 1q_3) = v^*$$

$$q_1(4p) + q_2(12p - 2) + q_3(5 - 6p) = v^*$$

A bigger example

		B plays			
		q_1	q_2	q_3	
A plays	$1-p$ a_1	b_1	b_2	b_3	
	p a_2	b_1	b_2	b_3	
		0	-2	5	$-2q_2 + 5q_3$
		4	10	-1	$4q_1 + 10q_2 - 1q_3$
		$4p$	$12p-2$	$5-6p$	



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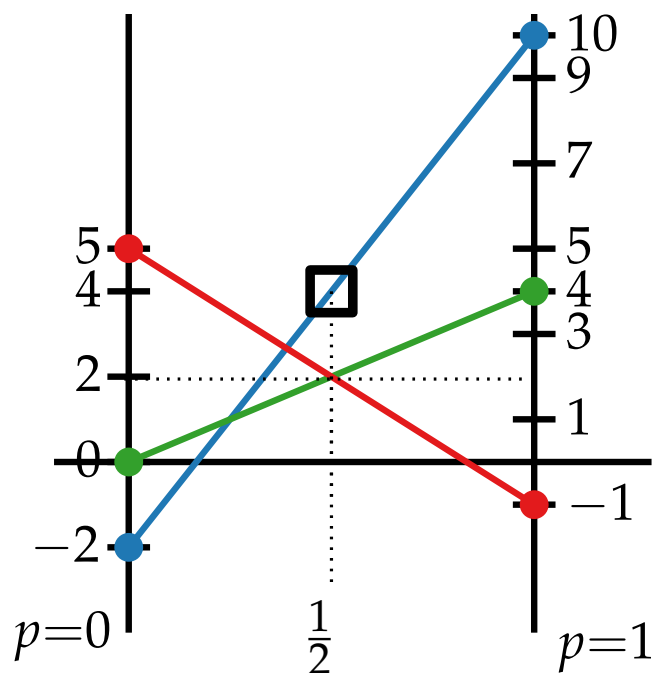
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$$p = 0 \rightsquigarrow -2q_2 + 5q_3 = 2$$

A bigger example

		B plays			
		q_1	q_2	q_3	
A plays	b_1	b_1	b_2	b_3	
	a_1	0	-2	5	$-2q_2 + 5q_3$
	a_2	4	10	-1	$4q_1 + 10q_2 - 1q_3$
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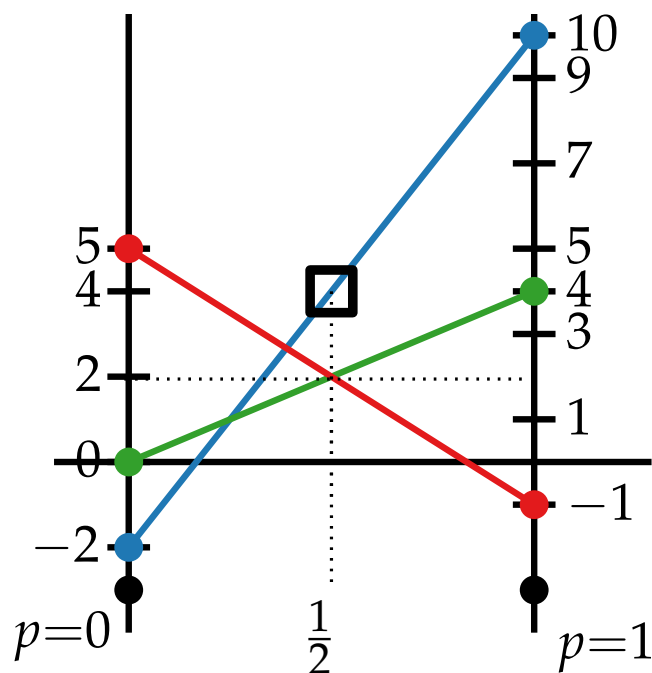
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A bigger example

		B plays			
		q_1	q_2	q_3	
A plays	a_1	b_1	b_2	b_3	
	a_2	b_1	b_2	b_3	
$1-p$	a_1	0	-2	5	$-2q_2 + 5q_3$
p	a_2	4	10	-1	$4q_1 + 10q_2 - 1q_3$
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Thus, $p = \frac{1}{2}$, and the **value** v^* of the game is 2.

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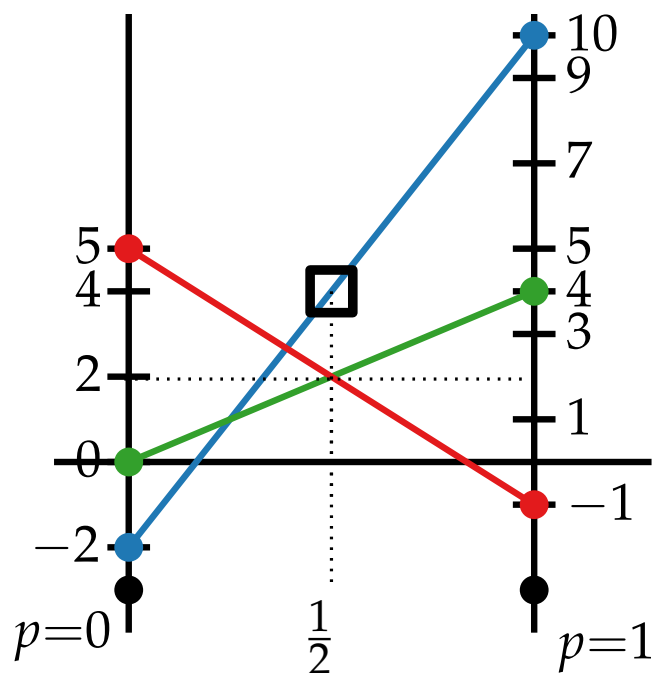
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$$p = 0 \rightsquigarrow -2q_2 + 5q_3 = 2 \quad \Rightarrow q_3 = \frac{2}{5}$$

$$p = 1 \rightsquigarrow 4q_1 - q_3 = 2 \quad \Rightarrow q_1 = \frac{3}{5}$$

A bigger example

		B plays			
		q_1	q_2	q_3	
A plays	b_1	b_2	b_3		
	a_1	a_2			
$1-p$	a_1	0	-2	5	$-2q_2 + 5q_3$
p	a_2	4	10	-1	$4q_1 + 10q_2 - 1q_3$
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But, we didn't find $\mathbf{q} = (q_1, q_2, q_3) \dots$

$$\Rightarrow q_2 = 0$$

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$$p = 1 \rightsquigarrow 4q_1 - q_3 = 2 \quad \Rightarrow q_1 = \frac{3}{5}$$

$$\mathbf{q} = \left(\frac{3}{5}, 0, \frac{2}{5}\right)$$

Flip the Matrix? [Let S be the (simplified) game of prev. slide]

B plays

A plays

$$\begin{matrix} & b_1 & b_2 \\ a_1 & 0 & 4 \\ a_2 & -2 & 10 \\ a_3 & 5 & -1 \end{matrix} = S^T$$

- Is this the same game?

Flip the Matrix? [Let S be the (simplified) game of prev. slide]

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- Is this the same game?
No, payoff/loss is reversed!

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$$\begin{array}{c} \text{B plays} \\ \text{A plays} \end{array} \begin{array}{cc} & b_1 & b_2 \\ \begin{array}{c} a_1 \\ a_2 \\ a_3 \end{array} & \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 4 \\ -2 & 10 \\ 5 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \end{array} = S^T$$

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$$\begin{array}{c} \text{B plays} \\ \text{A plays} \end{array} \begin{array}{cc} b_1 & b_2 \\ a_1 & \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \\ a_2 & \begin{bmatrix} -2 & 10 \end{bmatrix} \\ a_3 & \begin{bmatrix} 5 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \end{array} = S^T$$

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- What about this game?

Flip the Matrix? [Let S be the (simplified) game of prev. slide]

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